Writing Challenges

Concept

A challenge is the final thought that leaves the reader considering the meaning or implications of an essay.

Purpose

Give the reader a reason to keep thinking after the conclusion.

Forms

A thoughtful question, strong statement, vivid image, relevant quotation, warning, suggestion or call to action.

Earn the ending

The final thought should follow from the argument already developed.

Proportion

Avoid dramatic warnings or sweeping claims that the essay has not supported.

Placement

Usually the last sentence of the whole essay, after the main ideas have been brought together.

Writing Challenges

Example 1 | original model

End an essay proposing a shared classroom bookshelf.

Solution / why it works

1. Question: What might change if every student could recommend a book to the next reader?

2. Action: Start with one shelf, then invite each class to contribute a recommendation.

3. Why these work: both grow from the proposal and give the reader a concrete next thought.

Writing Challenges

Practice | your turn

1. Write a rhetorical question ending for an essay about reducing classroom waste.

2. Write an action ending for the same essay.

3. Choose the better ending for your intended audience and explain why.

Writing Challenges

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible question: What could our classroom save by using each page twice?

2

Possible action: Place a scrap-paper tray beside the printer and use it for first drafts.

3

Choose the ending that fits the essay's evidence and audience; neither form is always better.

Source & editing note

Writing Challenges.pdf | 1 supplied pages.

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